

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 5 2
 ♥ Q J 9 4 3
 ♦ Q 4
 ♣ J 9

♠ A 6 3
 ♥ 7 5 2
 ♦ A 7 5 3
 ♣ 10 5 4



♠ K 9
 ♥ 10 8 6
 ♦ K J 9
 ♣ 8 7 6 3 2

♠ Q J 7 4
 ♥ A K
 ♦ 10 8 6 2
 ♣ A K Q

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	2 ♦	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South

and then a small ♠ back toward your ♠ Q J. Here East puts the ♠ K on and you are home-free.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♥ Q.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 7

You need two more winners and ♦ s is your longest combined suit. But you can only establish one extra winner in ♦ s, and before you could even do that the defenders would have taken a bunch of ♥ tricks.

So you must turn to the ♠ s for the extra two winners.

You win the first ♥ and lead . . . which ♠? If you play the ♠ Q you will go down, even if West has the ♠ K. He would cover and you would be held to just 2 ♠ tricks.

The only way to get 3 tricks from this holding is to play East for the ♠ K. So play a ♠ to dummy's ♠ A

You were a little lucky that East's ♠ K fell on the second round.

If it had not dropped you would just have played a third round of ♠ s, hoping for a 3-3 split in the suit.

Clickagain.

You could also have gotten 3 ♠ winners with this distribution.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ 8 7 6

♦ 7 3

♣ A K 8 2

♠ A 7 5

♥ A J 3

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 6 3



♠ K J 8 4

♥ 10 9 4 2

♦ Q J 10 5

♣ 5

♠ Q 3

♥ K Q 5

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ Q J 7 4

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

The chance of ♦s splitting 3-3 is about 40%.

So you should enter dummy with a ♥ and play a small ♠ toward your ♠Q.

Did it work?

You might have thought of another possibility; duck a ♦, then play ♦A and ♦K to see if the ♦s split before you try leading toward the ♠Q.

The problem is that you might run into this very distribution. You would establish a ♦ for East and when you played a ♠ from dummy East would jump up with the ♠K and cash his winning ♦ for down 1.

South is to play 3NT. West leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. East follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

West leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. East follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=3 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 8

There are two possibilities for getting an extra winner. If the ♦s are splitting 3-3 you could play ♦A, ♦K and another ♦ and establish the thirteenth ♦ as a winner. Or you could play East for the ♠K and lead toward your ♠Q.

The chance of East holding the ♠K is a little greater than 50%. (it is higher than the usual 50% because we know he started with only one ♣, giving him more spaces for other cards).

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 8 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5



♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 10 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3

♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Pass	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			